

Non-Technical Guide: Building Business SOPs & Rules from Scratch

A step-by-step roadmap for domain research, AI-assisted drafting, and structured SOP authoring.

Target Role **Team Member 4 (Domain Analyst)**

Technical Knowledge Required **Zero (No Coding Required)**

Output Artifacts **4 Formatted SOP Worksheets**

💡 Mission & Mindset

You are acting as the **Chief Operating Officer (COO)** of our hypothetical global logistics enterprise: **Apex Global Logistics & Freight Corp.** Your mission is to author the official corporate rulebook so that our GenAI Copilot can make decisions like a 20-year veteran supply chain director.

🚀 4-Step Research & Drafting Roadmap

1

Industry Research

Find real policies from Maersk, DHL, Pfizer & FedEx.

2

AI Prompting

Use ChatGPT / Gemini to draft rule templates.

3

Fill Worksheets

Fill out 4 tables in Word, Excel or Docs.

4

Hand-Off

Pass filled worksheets to developers to build JSON.

🔍 Phase 1: Where to Find Real-World Reference Data

You do not need to invent business rules out of nowhere! Base your rules on public contracts, SLAs, and tariffs from industry leaders:

Industry Sector	Target Reference Companies	Recommended Google Search Queries	Key Data Points to Extract
Ocean Container Freight	Maersk, MSC, Hapag-Lloyd, Flexport	"Maersk Demurrage tariff guide pdf" "Ocean freight bill of lading terms"	Free-time at port (3–5 days), daily demurrage penalty (\$150–\$350/day).
Air Freight & Express	DHL Express, FedEx Freight, UPS	"DHL freight delay money back guarantee" "Air freight expedite cost per kg benchmark"	Air freight cost multiplier (4x–6x ocean fee), 2-day delivery SLA.
Cold-Chain & Perishables	Pfizer, Thermo King, Sensitech, WHO	"WHO cold chain temperature deviation guide" "Pharma cargo temperature excursion SOP"	Ambient range (15–25°C), Cold range (2–8°C). Breach >4 hrs = Spoilage Claim.
Disruption Management	McKinsey Supply Chain, Gartner Top 25	"Port congestion diversion strategy whitepaper"	Rerouting thresholds when ocean vessel delay exceeds 48 hours.

Phase 2: Copy-Paste ChatGPT & Gemini Prompts

Use AI as your personal research assistant. Copy and paste these exact prompts into ChatGPT or Gemini to draft your business rules:

Prompt 1: Ocean Freight Rerouting & Delay SOP "Act as a Senior Director of Global Supply Chain. Write a 1-page Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for handling ocean freight transit delays caused by severe weather or port congestion. Include trigger conditions (e.g. delay > 48 hours), approved mitigation actions (e.g. feeder port reroute, partial air freight expedite), cost estimates, and mandatory compliance checks."

Prompt 2: Carrier Penalty & Demurrage Tariff Table "Generate a realistic penalty and demurrage matrix table for international ocean and air freight shipments. List vessel type, free time days, daily penalty fee after free time, and standard grace period based on real carrier policies like Maersk and DHL."

Prompt 3: Management Approval Escalation Matrix "Create a 4-tier financial approval escalation matrix for a logistics control tower. Define roles (Dispatcher, Logistics Manager, Regional Director, VP of Ops), their maximum dollar approval limits for mitigating delays, and what actions each role is authorized to approve."

Phase 3: The 4 Ready-to-Use Worksheets

Fill out these 4 worksheets in Word, Excel, or Google Docs. This is all the input the dev team needs!

Worksheet 1: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) Form

SOP Field	Example Content (Fill in your values)
SOP ID & Title	SOP-LOG-001: High-Risk Ocean Freight Delay Protocol
Target Cargo Type	High-Value Electronics / Automotive Parts
Trigger Conditions	ML Late Risk > 70% AND Delay > 2.0 Days AND Cargo Value > \$50,000
Recommended Action	Divert vessel to secondary feeder port with lower queue congestion.
Primary Action Cost	\$2,500 flat diversion fee + \$300 per day in transit
Emergency Alternative	Partial Air Expedite: Fly 25% urgent cargo; leave 75% on ocean vessel.
Emergency Action Cost	\$12,500 estimated air cargo freight charge
Expected Outcome	Reduces ETA delay by 3 to 4 days; avoids \$20,000 SLA penalty.

Worksheet 2: Carrier Penalty & Demurrage Rules

Transport Mode	Carrier Tier	Free Time Allowed	Daily Penalty Rate	SLA Breach Fine
Ocean Freight (Dry)	Tier 1 (Maersk/MSC)	5 Days at Port	\$250 / Day / Container	\$1,000 flat penalty
Ocean Freight (Reefer)	Tier 1 (Maersk/MSC)	2 Days at Port	\$550 / Day / Container	\$2,500 fine + inspection fee
Air Freight Express	DHL / FedEx	24 Hours at Hub	\$1,200 / Day	\$5,000 SLA breach fine
Inland Trucking / Rail	Intermodal Express	12 Hours at Ramp	\$150 / Hour	\$500 flat fine

Worksheet 3: IoT Sensor & Environmental Safety Thresholds

Sensor Parameter	Normal Range	Warning Level Investigate	Critical Level Emergency SOP
Vessel Speed (SOG)	14.0 – 20.0 knots	10.0 – 13.9 knots	
Sea Wave Height	0.5 – 3.0 meters	3.1 – 4.9 meters	≥ 5.0 meters (Storm / Severe swell alert)
Cold-Chain Temp (Pharma)	2.0°C – 8.0°C	8.1°C – 10.0°C (>1 hr)	> 10.0°C (>4 hrs = Cargo Spoilage Claim)
Humidity (Electronics)	30% – 50%	51% – 65%	> 65% (Moisture condensation damage)

Worksheet 4: Operator Financial Escalation Matrix

Level	Role Title	Max Spend Cap (\$)	Authorized Actions
Level 1	Logistics Dispatcher	Up to \$2,500	Issue port priority alert, adjust vessel speed alert, carrier alert.
Level 2	Supply Chain Manager	Up to \$25,000	Approve feeder port reroute, approve partial air freight expedite.
Level 3	Regional Logistics Director	Up to \$100,000	Authorize carrier contract override, full cargo re-shipment.
Level 4	VP of Global Operations	Unlimited (\$100k+)	Authorize insurance claim, carrier contract termination, C-suite alert.

Completion Checklist for Team Member 4

- Select 2–3 real-world logistics company policies (e.g. Maersk, DHL, Pfizer).
- Run the 3 provided prompts in ChatGPT or Gemini to get draft rules.
- Fill out the 4 Worksheets in Word, Excel, or Google Docs.
- Pass the completed document to Team Members 1, 2, and 3 for JSON conversion!

SmartTrack AI Logistics Control Tower — Internal Team Documentation & Guide — Confidential